The Journal — Implementation Guide

Village Woodworking · March 2026

READ PAGES 5-8 FOR UPDATES

What You're Working With

Three files, each with a specific role:

File	Purpose
`journal.html`	Landing page — password gate, subscriber capture, filterable post grid
`journal-post.html`	Individual post template — rich content layout with access check
`vw-journal-appscript-snippet.js`	Apps Script update — routes subscriber data to a new Google Sheets tab

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Step 1: Update Google Apps Script (Do This First)

The journal gate sends subscriber data to the same Apps Script endpoint your portfolio and intake forms already use. You need to add a handler for the new `"Journal Subscriber"` source value so the data lands in its own tab.

1a. Create the Sheet Tab

1. Open the Google Sheet connected to your Apps Script
2. Click the **+** at the bottom to add a new tab
3. Name it exactly: **Journal Subscribers**
4. In Row 1, add these headers:

A	B	C	D
Timestamp	Email	First Name	Last Name

1b. Update the Apps Script

1. Open **Extensions → Apps Script** from the Google Sheet
2. Find your existing `doPost(e)` function

3. Locate the section where it checks `data.source` to route to different tabs (you'll see `'Intake Form'` and the portfolio handler already there)
4. Add this block alongside the existing source checks:

```javascript
if (data.source === 'Journal Subscriber') {
  var sheet = ss.getSheetByName('Journal Subscribers');
  if (!sheet) {
    sheet = ss.insertSheet('Journal Subscribers');
    sheet.appendRow(['Timestamp', 'Email', 'First Name', 'Last Name']);
  }
  sheet.appendRow([
    data.timestamp || new Date().toISOString(),
    data.email     || '',
    data.firstName || '',
    data.lastName  || ''
  ]);
}
```

If your `doPost` doesn't route by source yet, `vw-journal-appscript-snippet.js` includes a complete replacement `doPost` (Option B) that handles all three sources. Review it, adapt column order to match your existing sheet structure, and replace the entire function.

1c. Redeploy

1. Click **Deploy → Manage Deployments**
2. Click the pencil icon on your existing deployment
3. Under **Version**, select **New version**
4. Click **Deploy**

The endpoint URL stays the same. The new version just picks up the code change.

Step 2: Add Files to Your Site

File Placement

Both HTML files go in the root of your site — the same directory as `index.html`, `about.html`, `portfolio.html`, etc.

```
your-site/
├── index.html
├── about.html
├── portfolio.html
├── intake.html
├── contact.html
├── journal.html          ← new
├── journal-post.html     ← new (duplicate per post)
├── css/
│   ├── bootstrap.css
│   ├── style.css
│   └── vw-fonts.css
├── js/
│   ├── jquery-3.4.1.min.js
│   ├── bootstrap.js
│   └── custom.js
└── images/
```

No new CSS or JS files are needed. All journal styles are scoped inside each HTML file's `<style>` block.

Verify Asset Paths

Both templates reference these existing files — confirm they resolve correctly from your root:

- `css/bootstrap.css`
- `css/style.css`
- `css/vw-fonts.css`
- `css/font-awesome.min.css`
- `js/jquery-3.4.1.min.js`
- `js/bootstrap.js`
- `js/custom.js`
- `images/VWfavicon.png`

If your CSS/JS live at different paths, update the `<link>` and `<script>` tags in both files.

Step 3: Set the Access Code

In `journal.html`, near the top of the `<script>` block, you'll find:

```javascript
```

```
const VW_JOURNAL_PASSWORD = "villageworks";
```

Change `"villageworks"` to whatever code you want to distribute. This is the single value visitors enter to unlock the journal. Update it anytime — only new sessions are affected (existing sessions keep access until the browser closes).

Step 4: Add Journal to Your Navigation

Both journal templates already include a "Journal" link in their own nav bars. To make it accessible from the rest of your site, add this `<li>` to the navbar `<ul>` in each of your existing pages (`index.html`, `about.html`, `portfolio.html`, `intake.html`, `contact.html`):

```html
<li class="nav-item">
  <a class="nav-link" href="journal.html">Journal</a>
</li>
```

Place it after "Portfolio" and before "FAQs" to match the order already set in the journal templates.

You'll also want to add it to the footer navigation in each page. Inside `.vw_footer__nav-group` (the "Navigate" column), add:

```html
<li><a href="journal.html">Journal</a></li>
```

Step 5: Publish Your First Post

On the Landing Page (journal.html)

Each post is represented by a card in the `#postGrid` container. The template ships with three example cards. To add a real post:

1. Duplicate one of the `<a class="jrnl_card">` blocks
2. Update these fields:

Field	What to change
`data-category`	`"in-the-shop"`, `"process"`, or `"studying"`
`href`	Path to the post file, e.g. `"journal/first-post.html"`
`.jrnl_card__category` text	Display label: "In the Shop", "Process", or "Studying"
`.jrnl_card__media img`	`src` and `alt` for the card thumbnail
`.jrnl_card__title`	Post title
`.jrnl_card__excerpt`	2–3 sentence summary
`.jrnl_card__date`	Publish date (e.g. "Mar 2026")

Delete the three example cards once you have real content.

The Post File (journal-post.html)

1. Duplicate `journal-post.html` and rename it (e.g. `first-post.html`)
2. Update the `<title>` tag: `"Your Post Title | Journal | Village Woodworking"`
3. Update the `<meta name="description">` for SEO / social sharing
4. In the `.post_hero` section, update:
   - `.post_hero__category` — category label
   - `.post_hero__title` — post title
   - `.post_hero__meta` — date and estimated read time
5. Replace the `.post_cover img` src with your hero image (or remove the block entirely)
6. Write your content in the `<article class="post_content">` area

Available Content Components

The post template supports these blocks — all documented in HTML comments inside the file:

Text:

```html
<p>Paragraph text.</p>
<h2>Section Heading</h2>
<h3>Sub-heading</h3>
```

Pull Quote:

```html
<div class="post_pullquote">
  <p>Quote text here.</p>
  <cite>— Attribution</cite>
</div>
```

Single Image with Caption:

```html
<div class="post_img">
  <img src="images/photo.jpg" alt="Description" />
  <div class="post_img__caption">Caption text.</div>
</div>
```

Side-by-Side Images:

```html
<div class="post_img-grid">
  <img src="images/left.jpg" alt="Left" />
  <img src="images/right.jpg" alt="Right" />
</div>
```

Video Embed (YouTube or Vimeo):

```html
<div class="post_video">
  <iframe src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/VIDEO_ID"
    allow="accelerometer; autoplay; clipboard-write; encrypted-media; gyroscope"
    allowfullscreen></iframe>
</div>
```

Divider:

```html
<div class="post_divider"></div>
```

Tags:

```html
<div class="post_tags">
  <span class="post_tag">Walnut</span>
  <span class="post_tag">CNC</span>
</div>
```

Post Navigation (Prev / Next)

At the bottom of each post file, update the `.post_nav` links to point to the actual previous and next posts. Remove either link block if there's no adjacent post.

How the Gate Works

Understanding the flow so you can troubleshoot or explain it to others:

1. Visitor lands on `journal.html` → dark overlay with form appears
2. Visitor enters email (required), name (optional), and access code (required)
3. JavaScript validates the code against `VW_JOURNAL_PASSWORD`
4. If correct → subscriber data is POSTed to Google Sheets via your Apps Script, then `sessionStorage` stores `vw_journal_access = "true"` and the overlay fades out
5. If the POST to Sheets fails for any reason, the gate still unlocks — subscriber capture is best-effort, content access is the priority
6. For the rest of that browser session, the gate is skipped on both `journal.html` and any `journal-post.html` page
7. If someone navigates directly to a post URL without going through the gate, they see a locked state with a redirect button back to `journal.html`

Implications

- Closing and reopening the browser resets access (new session)
- This is a soft gate — it's not meant to be bulletproof security. It's a subscriber capture mechanism with a code that controls distribution
- The code is visible in the page source. That's fine for this use case. Anyone determined enough to view-source was never going to be stopped by a client-side gate anyway

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Organizing Multiple Posts

As your post count grows, consider moving posts into a subdirectory:

```
your-site/
├── journal.html
└── journal/
    ├── first-post.html
    ├── second-post.html
    └── images/
        ├── first-post-cover.jpg
        └── ...
```

If you do this, update the asset paths in each post file (e.g. `../css/style.css` instead of `css/style.css`) and the card `href` values in `journal.html` (e.g. `journal/first-post.html`).

Checklist

- [ ] Google Sheet has a "Journal Subscribers" tab with headers
- [ ] Apps Script updated with the Journal Subscriber routing block
- [ ] Apps Script redeployed (new version)
- [ ] `journal.html` placed in site root
- [ ] `journal-post.html` placed in site root (or duplicated per post)
- [ ] `VW_JOURNAL_PASSWORD` set to your chosen code
- [ ] Journal nav link added to existing pages (header + footer)
- [ ] Example cards replaced with real content (or removed)
- [ ] Post file(s) populated with actual content and images
- [ ] Tested: gate appears → code works → data lands in Sheets → content unlocks